

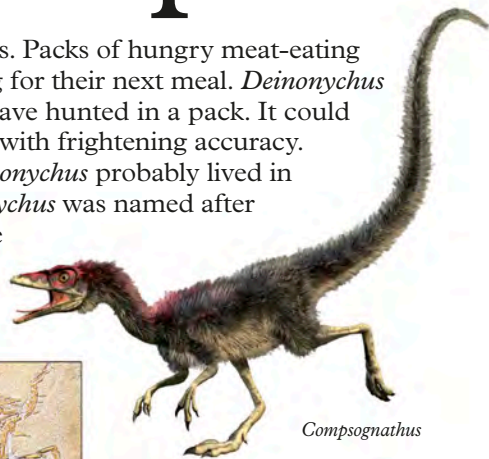


HUNTING IN PACKS

Not all dinosaurs were plant-eaters. Packs of hungry meat-eating dinosaurs roamed around, looking for their next meal. *Deinonychus* was a small dinosaur that might have hunted in a pack. It could outrun its prey and pounce to kill with frightening accuracy. Dinosaurs much bigger than *Deinonychus* probably lived in fear of this speedy hunter. *Deinonychus* was named after its most deadly weapon—its name means “terrible claw.”

Running reptiles

Deinonychus was in a family of feathered meat-eating dinosaurs called the dromaeosaurids, which means “running reptiles.”



Compsognathus



Compsognathus fossil

Lizard lunch

Many pack-hunting dinosaurs chased other dinosaurs, but the smaller hunters enjoyed a diet of lizards or shrewlike mammals. This fossil of the hen-sized *Compsognathus* has the bones of its last meal inside its stomach. It was a Bavarisaurus lizard.

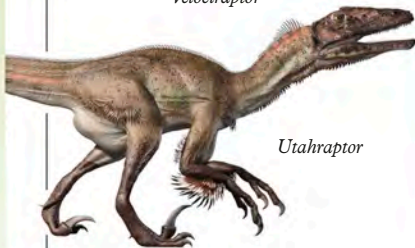
Sharp eyesight was very useful for spotting prey.



Sinornithosaurus



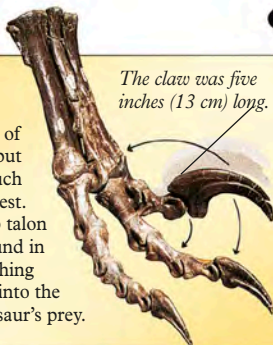
Velociraptor



Utahaptor

Deadly claw

Deinonychus had a claw on the tip of each of its toes, but one claw was much bigger than the rest. This huge, sharp talon could swipe around in a semicircle, slashing a deadly wound into the flesh of the dinosaur's prey.



The claw was five inches (13 cm) long.